

Chief of Staff

A personal Chief of Staff that runs inside Claude. Getting started takes about ten minutes, and you don't need any AI experience.

Created by **Garrett Lommatsch** · www.lommatsch.com · linkedin.com/in/garrett-lommatsch

What is this?

Chief of Staff (CoS) turns Claude into the person every executive wishes they had: someone who keeps the full picture of your work, watches your calendar and inbox, remembers what you said you'd do, and tells you each morning what deserves your attention. It works for job searches, side projects, content goals, family logistics, or just surviving a busy career.

It is direct by design. If you said you'd do something and didn't, it will bring it up. If you're overcommitted, it will say so. And when it encourages you, it points at real evidence of your progress, never empty cheerleading.

What it can do

Morning and weekly briefings	Your calendar, inbox, commitments, and a recommended focus, synthesized into one view on request.
Drafts, never surprises	It prepares calendar blocks and emails for you, but creates nothing without your explicit yes. It can never send an email; drafts land in your Gmail drafts folder for you to send.
Accountability with teeth	Commitments get logged with a specific time slot. Unfinished ones get raised, then escalated. A 3-item active limit keeps your list honest.
Meeting prep dossiers	Say "prep me for the 2pm" and get who's attending, your email history with them, open threads, and talking points.
Week planning into real blocks	"Plan my week" proposes calendar blocks matched to your personal energy pattern. Approve once, and they appear.
Job-search pipeline (optional)	Tracks every application and recruiter by stage, flags anything quiet for 7+ days, and writes the follow-up emails.
Decision journal	Log big decisions with what you expect to happen. It resurfaces them months later and shows you how good your judgment actually is.

Capture from anywhere	Email yourself with a subject starting "cos:" from your phone. It lands in your commitment log automatically.
Grounded coaching	Encouragement based on the psychology of motivation: specific, evidence-backed, and honest. If the week was bad, it says so.

Setup — five steps, about ten minutes

1. Get Claude with Cowork

You need the Claude desktop app with Cowork mode (a Claude feature for working with your files and apps). Download the app at claude.ai/download, sign in, and open a Cowork session. A paid Claude plan is required.

2. Install the plugin

Drag the file **chief-of-staff.plugin** (included alongside this guide) into a Cowork chat and type: *"Please install this plugin."* Claude will show a save/install button - click it. You can also add it from Settings > Capabilities.

3. Connect Google Calendar and Gmail

In Claude's Settings, find Connectors and connect Google Calendar and Gmail, signing in with the Google account you actually use day to day. This is what lets your Chief of Staff see your schedule and inbox. (It can run without them, but this is where most of the value is.)

4. Pick a working folder

When Cowork asks which folder to work in, pick or create one (e.g., a folder called "Chief of Staff" in Documents). The skill keeps its memory files there - plain text files you can open and read anytime.

5. Run setup

Type: **cos setup** - Claude will interview you for a few minutes: what to call you, when your energy peaks, what your real priorities are, who you want to stay in touch with, and dates worth remembering. Answer naturally; it stores the profile and you're done.

That's it. From now on, just talk to it.

Daily use — the phrase cheat sheet

You say...	You get...
morning brief / what should I focus on	Today's schedule, open time, commitments, suggested focus
what does my week look like	Day-by-day week preview with deadlines and prep flags

plan my week / block my time	Proposed calendar blocks to approve in one go
prep me for [meeting or person]	A prep dossier from your email history
I have an hour - what should I do	One specific recommendation plus a backup
update - I just finished X	Logs progress, closes the commitment, suggests what's next
pipeline / where are my applications	Job-search status table with drafted follow-ups
decide: [your decision]	Logs it in your decision journal with a future check-in date
weekly review / how did last week go	Honest said-vs-did scorecard for the week

Three habits that make it sing

Tell it what you intend to do.

Say things like "I'm going to finish the proposal Friday morning." It will pin the commitment to a time slot and check whether it actually happened. This when-then technique is one of the best-evidenced tools in behavioral psychology for follow-through.

Capture on the go.

Anywhere, anytime: email yourself with a subject line starting "cos:" (e.g., "cos: call the accountant about Q3"). Next time you check in, it's already on your list.

Do a weekly review.

Once a week, ask "how did last week go." The honest gap between what you said and what you did is where the system earns its keep.

Privacy and safety

Everything stays yours. The skill's memory lives in plain text files in the folder you chose - open them anytime. It can read your calendar and email only through the connectors you approve, it never sends email (only drafts that you send yourself), and it never creates or changes a calendar event without showing you first and getting your yes. Events it creates are prefixed [CoS] so you can always spot and remove them.

If something doesn't work

It says a connector isn't available

Check Settings > Connectors in Claude and reconnect Google Calendar or Gmail. The skill still works without them, just with less visibility.

It didn't run the setup interview

Type "cos setup" directly.

It's nagging me about something I finished

Just say "update - I did that on Tuesday." It corrects the log and apologizes for doubting you.

I want it gentler / stricter / different

Tell it. Say "be gentler about the nagging" or "stop tracking my posting cadence" - preferences stick via Claude's memory.

Can it run automatically every morning?

Yes - ask Claude to "schedule my morning brief for 7am on weekdays."

About the creator

This skill was designed and built by **Garrett Lommatsch**, a technology leader who builds practical AI systems at the intersection of product, business, and execution - tools that change what a single person can get done in a day. The Chief of Staff is one of them; there is more where it came from.

See his work at www.lommatsch.com or connect at linkedin.com/in/garrett-lommatsch. If this skill saves your week, he would like to hear about it - and if you share it onward, keep this page with it.

MIT license. The original version grew out of Annie Tsai's open-source /cos skill (MomsinTech).